

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at Deloitte,

I trained as an architect, and the part of the work that has always drawn me most is the one that comes before the project itself - understanding what a site is worth and what it could become once its regulatory and physical constraints are properly read. Following that question is what took me from architecture practice into development feasibility, and then to a Master's Degree in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy, where I specialised in the computational and data methods that allow those questions to be answered with evidence rather than intuition. Alongside that, the environmental performance of buildings has been a constant thread in my work, from assessing the energy performance of assets a bank was acquiring to ESG due diligence for real estate investment managers, which is increasingly part of what an asset is worth rather than a separate conversation about it. Deloitte's M&A Transaction Services team applies that same reading to whole companies rather than to single sites, and testing whether the numbers a buyer has been shown actually hold is the work I want to be doing.

At OSPA I produced multiple feasibility studies for residential and mixed-use developments across Brazil and the United States, sizing investment and return for each candidate site against buildable area, unit mix, price per square metre and parking, while reading the municipal master plan and land-use law to establish how much development potential the site actually carried. What that work taught me is that the number a client commits capital against is only as good as the regulatory reading underneath it, and that the two have to be produced together rather than in sequence. Financial due diligence asks for that discipline on a larger object, since a review of historical trading and a forecast only mean something once the operating reality underneath them has been read as carefully as the figures.

At Itaú-Unibanco I reviewed technical documentation from architecture and engineering firms before construction was authorised, checking drawings against Brazilian building, accessibility and fire-safety standards, and assessed the environmental and energy performance of buildings the bank was acquiring or leasing by reviewing consumption data, efficiency ratings and certifications as part of internal due diligence. Sitting on the owner's side of that process taught me what an institution actually needs to see before it commits to a building, which is a different and narrower question than the one a design team asks. That is the position this role occupies on behalf of a buyer or a seller, establishing what is actually there before capital moves.

Deloitte advises private equity firms and corporates deciding whether to buy or sell a business, and the answer those clients need rests on financial analysis that survives being checked by the other side. That is where I want to bring the architect's reading of an asset and the analytical side of my work into the same job, applied to real assets and to decisions with money behind them.

Best,

Antonio Carmagnani